

Daily Need to Know

Friday, 25 September 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
<i>US cash equities & volatility — settled 16:00 ET Thu 24 Sep = 04:00 GMT+8, 2h 09m old at capture</i>			
S&P 500	7,704.13	▼ 1.90 -0.02%	Was -0.54% at 7,664 intraday, closed at 74% of the day's range. 71.7% of Hedgeye's 7540–7769 band; 1.4% below the 52-week high. Equal-weight RSP -0.50% : the flat print is a mega-cap print.
Nasdaq Composite	26,939.37	▲ 3.34 +0.01%	Recovered 223 points from the low to close at 88% of range. 56.5% of the 26309–27425 band. Meta and Alphabet did the lifting.
Dow Jones Industrial	51,349.98	▼ 161.61 -0.31%	Third straight loss; recovered 210 points off the low. 6.2% below its 52-week high.
Russell 2000	2,835.57	▼ 3.09 -0.11%	Traded 2,810.75 — below Hedgeye's new 2814 floor — then closed at 89% of range. 25.1% of the bearish 2814–2900 band. 7.6% below its 52-week high.
Philadelphia SOX	12,492.55	▼ 41.73 -0.33%	Closed at 90% of range. Split tape: AMD +2.38% (record close) and INTC +3.91% against WDC -4.94% , SNDK -3.47% . 14.8% below the 52-week high.
VIX	15.68	▲ 0.51 +3.36%	Spiked to 16.57, closed at 28% of range. 36.5% of the bearish 14.20–18.25 band. Bond vol did the work: MOVE +9.6% to 104.6 , 6.7× the VIX.
<i>US index futures — Thursday settles at 06:09 capture; Globex reopened 06:00 GMT+8, live prints appended from the 06:14 re-pull</i>			
ES (E-mini S&P, Dec)	7,767.00	▼ 5.50 -0.07%	Settle; ties to Wednesday's 7,772.50 exactly. Basis to cash +62.9pts , consistent with a settle. Live 06:14: 7,763 (-4), 876 contracts in 14 minutes — not information.
NQ (E-mini Nasdaq-100)	30,766.75	▲ 2.00 +0.01%	Range 30,370–30,827: a 457-point intraday recovery. Live 06:14: 30,751.50 (-15.25).
YM (E-mini Dow)	51,717	▼ 156 -0.30%	Basis +367pts. Live 06:14: 51,689 on 49 contracts.
RTY (E-mini Russell)	2,856.80	▼ 3.40 -0.12%	Basis +21.2. Live 06:14: 2,855.40.
<i>US Treasury yields — cash series, New York close (TradingView, 18:09 ET)</i>			
US 10-year	5.208%	▲ 9.8bp	Highest since 2007 ; intraday 5.225% is the 52-week high. 5.8bp above the ceiling of Hedgeye's 4.92–5.15 band — a ceiling Hedgeye raised 6bp that morning. Second consecutive close through the top.
US 30-year	5.489%	▲ 9.2bp	52-week high 5.502% intraday; TheStreet put the close at the highest since 2004. 10s30s 28.1bp.
US 5-year	5.066%	▲ 6.9bp	Second day above 5%, on its 52-week high. 5s30s 42.3bp.
US 2-year	4.931%	▲ 3.4bp	The laggard. 2s10s 27.7bp, from 21.3bp Wednesday and a +20bp cycle low on Monday — a bear steepener. 29bp below the 5.22% Keith names as the next resistance.
US 13-week bill	4.182%	▲ 4.6bp	Closed on its high = 52-week high. Pricing another hike: fed funds top is 4.00%.
<i>Energy — front-month futures, Thursday settles; live prints from 06:14</i>			
WTI (CL, Nov)	\$94.61	▲ 2.45 +2.66%	Ties to Wednesday's 92.16. High 96.78, faded on the Hormuz-talks report. 33.2% of the 87.61–108.68 band. Live 94.43.
Brent (BZ1!, Nov)	\$106.60	▲ 3.52 +3.41%	Expiring November contract (ties to 103.08); Eurasia Business News prints the same 106.60. High 108.23. The December benchmark was not captured — see §18.
Natural gas	\$3.297	▲ 0.274 +9.06%	Closed 18.7¢ above Hedgeye's 3.11 ceiling — two days after the TREND upgrade. Reopened at 3.209 and printed 3.184 (-3.4%) on 75 contracts : a thin gap, not yet a reversal.
RBOB gasoline	\$3.333	▼ 0.007 -0.22%	Crude up, gasoline flat: the crack narrowed after Wednesday's 3.67% jump.
<i>Metals — SPOT, the series Hedgeye names; session rolled 18:00 ET, change measured against yesterday's 06:01 capture</i>			
Gold spot	\$4,272.43	▼ 17.17 -0.40%	COMEX GC settled 4,298.00 (-0.47%). 46.1% of a band Hedgeye moved down \$43 and re-signalled bearish (from neutral). Keith is below his minimum gold weight.
Silver spot	\$63.75	▼ 0.67 -1.03%	SI futures -1.48% to 64.00. 68.8% of the narrowed bearish 61–65 band.
Copper spot	\$6.6685	▼ 0.0065 -0.10%	HG futures +0.54% to 6.79 — a 12¢ futures premium. 73.6% of the bullish 6.33–6.79 band.
<i>FX & crypto — live; FX majors rolled 17:00 ET, so the session is ~69 minutes old; change vs yesterday's 06:01 capture</i>			
DX1	101.249	▲ 0.135 +0.13%	Still carries Thursday's full session. Intraday 101.40, a new year-to-date high . 80.1% of the 99.92–101.58 bullish band.

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
USD/JPY	158.81	▲ 0.51 +0.32%	Keith flagged the yen breaking to bearish TREND vs USD Thursday. 3.2% below the 163.99 52-week high. In-session range 158.75–158.90: quiet.
USD/KRW	1,365.85	▲ 0.98 +0.07%	Korea shut for Chuseok; offshore marks only. Range 1,363–1,373.
Bitcoin	\$84,307	▼ 93 -0.11%	The only 24-hour row. Range 82,888–84,895. 53.1% of the 79k–89k range Keith cited; he is adding. 33.2% below the 52-week high.

▲ up ▼ down ♦ unchanged or not meaningful. Cash equity, VIX, Treasury and DXY rows are Thursday 24 September closes. Every other row captured 06:09:27–06:09:29 GMT+8 (2.2s) and re-pulled at 06:14:03. Futures were Thursday settles at 06:09 and had rolled into the new Globex session by 06:14. Cash prior closes, futures settles and the 2-, 5-, 10- and 30-year yields all tie exactly to yesterday's archived edition. Yahoo returned nothing (HTTP 429), so the second source is wire copy — see §18.

TL;DR — The 10-year closed at **5.208%**, the highest since 2007, and went through Hedgeye's risk-range ceiling for a **second straight day**, although Hedgeye had raised that ceiling 6bp in the morning. The 30-year hit **5.49%**. The curve **steepened** again: 2s10s went from 21.3bp to **27.7bp** because the long end sold harder than the front. Keith's desk expects the curve to flatten; so far it has not. The S&P recovered from -0.54% to close flat on the back of **Meta +4.5%** and Alphabet +1.3%, while the equal-weight index fell 0.50% and credit, utilities and long bonds all closed on 52-week lows. Oil rose on a fatal ship strike in Hormuz, then gave back part of the gain on a report of US–Iran talks on a phased reopening. **Today: August durable goods at 20:30 GMT+8, three Fed speakers, and day three of the Trump–Xi summit. Mainland China and Korea are shut.**

2 The big picture — what it means

- The bond market broke through the band Hedgeye had just widened to contain it.** On Wednesday the 10-year closed 2bp above a 5.09% ceiling. On Thursday morning Hedgeye raised the ceiling to 5.15%, and by the close the yield was **5.208%**, **5.8bp above it**. That is the second close through the top in two sessions, and the signal says the same thing each time: bullish TREND, and no lower high yet. Bond volatility confirms it. MOVE rose another **9.6% to 104.6**, on top of Wednesday's 21.5%.
- The curve is steepening, which is not the path Keith is forecasting.** Keith's Top 3 expects "further Yield Curve flattening and a potential curve inversion by early 2027." The tape did the opposite. The 10-year rose 9.8bp and the 2-year only 3.4bp, so 2s10s widened to **27.7bp**, from a +20bp low on Monday. The same morning's Early Look, written by Matthew Cooper, reads it differently: the problem is falling demand for duration, not the Fed. On the last two sessions the tape agrees with Cooper. A bear steepener after a tailed auction means investors are demanding more term premium. The Fed cannot vote that away.
- The flat S&P hid a down day for the average stock.** The S&P 500 finished -0.02% and the equal-weight RSP -0.50%, a **47bp** gap. Communication Services (+1.27%) was the best sector because Meta rose **4.50% to a new 52-week high** on volume 134% of average. Staples, utilities and materials closed at or near their lows. Keith cites Tier1 Alpha data showing more than 70% of S&P 500 stocks at least 10% below their highs. The index is being held up by a handful of names.
- Credit is at the floor.** HYG closed at **77.89, exactly on Hedgeye's new floor** and 4¢ above its 52-week low. LQD closed at 103.15, **25¢ below its floor**, after a 52-week low of 103.11. TLT closed on its 52-week low (79.42). XLU closed on its 52-week low at 0% of the day's range. Hedgeye is short all four. This is the part of the market that prices directly off the 5.2% 10-year, and it is not bouncing.
- Oil is caught between two opposite Hormuz headlines.** A commercial vessel was hit in the Strait, killing one crew member, and an adviser to Iran's supreme leader warned of a "new front" against Red Sea energy supplies. Brent's expiring November contract hit 108.23. Then a report that Washington and Tehran are discussing a **phased reopening of Hormuz and an end to the US blockade** took about \$1.60 off. WTI still settled **+2.66% at 94.61**, a third of the way up a \$21 band. Keith is long Brent with TRADE support at **\$97** and TREND support at **\$91** (BNO).
- The Fed is in a hiking cycle, and Thursday's data support more.** The FOMC hiked 25bp to **3.75–4.00%** on 16 September, 12–0. Thursday brought initial claims of **197K** and August new-home sales of **684K against 615K expected**, following Wednesday's five-year-high composite PMI. TheStreet puts the odds of an October hike at about **70%**. The 13-week bill at 4.18% has already priced most of it. The next FOMC decision is **27–28 October**.
- AI financing has become a rates story.** Oracle sent a **force majeure** notice on its New Mexico AI data centre, which could let it delay payments if the campus is not online in 2028. The stock fell as much as 7.7% intraday and closed **-3.47%**. The Early Look lists what else is priced off this curve: SoftBank marketing junk debt at around a 10% handle to fund OpenAI, a **\$1.1bn** CoreWeave construction deal, and more than **\$3tn** of hyperscaler off-balance-sheet commitments. The same day, Meta rallied on products that already bring in revenue (Connect hardware and the Muse agent). The market is separating companies that spend on AI from companies that earn from it.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- Treasuries:** 2y 4.931% (+3.4bp), 5y 5.066% (+6.9), 10y 5.208% (+9.8), 30y 5.489% (+9.2). 2s10s 27.7bp, 5s30s 42.3bp and 10s3m +102.6bp. The whole curve is at or within 2bp of its 52-week highs. The long end led for the second day in a row.
- Supply:** Wednesday's \$70bn 5-year auction cleared at **5.033%**, tailing more than 3bp. Per the Early Look, that was the second-worst 5-year auction since 2018, and the Treasury's **\$6bn buyback** did not stop the move. The Thursday 7-year result was not seen this morning.
- Global:** Keith cites the Australian 10-year **+12bp** on Thursday morning alone, which is why he is short EWA. The ASX 200 fell 0.72%.

- **Dollar:** DXY 101.249, intraday 101.40 (a year-to-date high), bullish TRADE and TREND per Hedgeye. EUR/USD 1.1378, 0.7% above its 52-week low. USD/CNH 6.714 is steady into the Xi visit.
- **Yen:** USD/JPY **158.81**. The yen flipped to bearish TREND against the dollar on Thursday, per Keith. Japan's 10-year spread to the 5.2% US 10-year is the widest pressure point in Asia this morning.
- **Energy:** WTI 94.61, Brent (Nov) 106.60, nat gas 3.297 (+9.1%, above band), RBOB flat. The Brent–WTI spread widened to **\$11.99** from \$10.92. The November Brent contract expires at month-end, so part of that is an expiry effect.
- **Metals:** Gold spot 4,272 (–0.40%) and silver 63.75 (–1.03%) both carry bearish TREND. Hedgeye downgraded gold from neutral on Thursday. Copper is the exception, bullish at 6.67 spot. Dollar up and real yields up is the combination Hedgeye calls negative for gold, and Keith is swapping gold units for Bitcoin.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

SIGNAL	READING	SOURCE & TIME (GMT+8)
Regime	Quad 2: "textbook #Quad2 Bond Yield Breakout both Locally and Globally"	KM's Top 3, Thu 19:21
Quad path	No explicit path notation seen. Keith refers to growth slowing "as expected into 2027" and "heading toward Quad 4" (Alphabet comment, AI summary). Nothing here asserts the path is unchanged.	Macro Show notes, Thu 23:44
Rates	Bond yields bullish TREND across the curve; the 2-year has "no longer-term resistance" until 5.22%	Early Look 19:49; KM Top 3
Dollar / Yen	Dollar bullish TRADE and TREND; yen broke to bearish TREND vs USD Thursday	KM's Top 3
Book	Cash raised to ~50%, then ~44%, and redeployed into energy and Bitcoin. Gold cut to ~1.5%, below minimum (AI summary)	Macro Show notes
Sector factors	Longs XLE, XLV, IGV ; shorts XLU, XLY, XLI ; top index short IWM (–7.5% from cycle peak)	KM's Top 3
Changes	ETF Pro: +BLOK long, –COLO . Signal Strength (52 names): added COIN, RBLX, CRCL, NVDA , HOOD , SNDK ; removed ACHC, RDNT, KXIAY	ETF Pro 22:32; SSS Fri 00:49

Risk Range™ Signals — Early Look "Nobody Wants the Paper", Thu 24 Sep 07:49 ET (19:49 GMT+8), Matthew Cooper

INSTRUMENT	RANGE	TREND	PRIOR (23 SEP)	Δ FLOOR / CEILING	WIDTH	WHERE IT STANDS NOW
UST 10-year yield	4.92–5.15	bullish	4.89–5.09	+0.03 / +0.06	0.20 → 0.23	5.208 — ABOVE the ceiling by 5.8bp. Second straight close through a ceiling that was raised to meet it.
High Yield (HYG)	77.89–78.76	bearish	78.30–79.00	–0.41 / –0.24	0.70 → 0.87	77.89 — exactly on the floor , 4¢ above the 52-week low. Band lowered to follow the price.
Inv. Grade (LQD)	103.4–105.2	bearish	103.8–105.6	–0.4 / –0.4	1.8 unchanged	103.15 — BELOW the floor by 0.25 ; 52-week low 103.11.
S&P 500 (SPX)	7540–7769	bullish	7536–7795	+4 / –26	259 → 229	7,704.13 — 71.7% . Ceiling cut 26 points; upside tightened.
Nasdaq Comp. (COMPQ)	26309–27425	bullish	26359–27351	–50 / +74	992 → 1,116	26,939.37 — 56.5%. Widened both ways.
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2814–2900	bearish	2846–2916	–32 / –16	70 → 86	2,835.57 — 25.1%. Low of 2,810.75 pierced the new floor intraday.
Health Care (XLV)	164–172	bullish	165–172	–1 / 0	7 → 8	169.87 — 73.4%. Long rose 0.63%.
Software (IGV)	102–110	bullish	101–110	+1 / 0	9 → 8	Not in the capture universe; position unknown.
Energy (XLE)	61.04–65.99	bullish	61.17–66.00	–0.13 / –0.01	4.83 → 4.95	62.60 — 31.5%. Up 0.37% but closed at 15% of range.
Volatility (VIX)	14.20–18.25	bearish	13.75–17.70	+0.45 / +0.55	3.95 → 4.05	15.68 — 36.5%. Band shifted up half a point.
US Dollar (USD)	99.92–101.58	bullish	99.79–101.25	+0.13 / +0.33	1.46 → 1.66	101.249 — 80.1%. Ceiling raised 33¢ after price nearly caught the old one.
Crude, WTIC continuous	87.61–108.68	bullish	87.51–109.07	+0.10 / –0.39	21.56 → 21.07	94.61 on CL1! — 33.2%.
Nat gas continuous	2.83–3.11	bullish	2.80–3.09	+0.03 / +0.02	0.29 → 0.28	3.297 — ABOVE the ceiling by 18.7¢ (167% of band). First new-session print 3.184 is still above it.
Gold spot	4206–4350	bearish ▼	4249–4383 (neutral)	–43 / –33	134 → 144	SIGNAL DOWNGRADED neutral → bearish . 4,272.43 on TVC:GOLD = 46.1%. On COMEX (4,298) it would misread 63.9%.
Copper spot	6.33–6.79	bullish	6.35–6.80	–0.02 / –0.01	0.45 → 0.46	6.6685 on OANDA spot — 73.6%. HG futures (6.79) would misread 100%, i.e. on the ceiling.
Silver spot	61–65	bearish	62–67	–1 / –2	5 → 4	63.75 — 68.8%. Ceiling cut \$2.

Prior bands come from the 23 September Early Look (07:25 ET, Keith McCullough) as reproduced in yesterday's archived edition; Hedgeye's category feed does not paginate. Positions are measured on the series Hedgeye names: spot for gold, silver and copper, and the continuous contract for crude and natural gas. The bands were published before Thursday's session. By the close, three of the sixteen had been broken (10-year, nat gas and LQD), all in the direction of Hedgeye's signal, and HYG sat on its floor.

Band moves in one line: one signal changed: **gold was downgraded to bearish** and its band cut \$43 at the floor. Every credit band (HYG, LQD) and the Russell band were moved lower, following the price down. The S&P ceiling was cut 26 points while the Nasdaq ceiling rose 74, so Hedgeye tightened the index where breadth is worst. The 10-year and dollar ceilings were both raised, and the 10-year broke the new one anyway. Nothing on the bearish side was relaxed.

What Keith actually said

- KM's Top 3 Things, Thu 24 Sep 07:21 ET / 19:21 GMT+8, on crude: "we're long Brent (BNO) with an Alpha Code of 9791 (TRADE = \$97, TREND = \$91), Mega Cap Energy (XLE), Refiners (CRAK) and Tankers (BWET)".
- On rates: "textbook #Quad2 Bond Yield Breakout both Locally and Globally"; and "No longer-term resistance for the UST2yr Yield to 5.22% (where it was in 2023) so we expect further Yield Curve flattening and a potential curve inversion by early 2027".
- On breadth: "Just over 70% of SPX Stocks are in at least a -10% Drawdown".
- The Early Look was written by **Matthew Cooper**, not Keith. Its key line: "A Fed problem is reversible. A problem with demand for duration isn't, because the Fed can't make anyone show up to an auction." The note opens with a Keith epigraph: "The Fractal Gods don't care if it makes sense. They just keep flowing."
- The Macro Show Summary Notes (Thu 11:44 ET / 23:44 GMT+8) say Keith named shorts in GS, MS and BAC, and in BALL, and said Hedgeye does not own Alphabet after its trend break. They also say he is adding Bitcoin toward the low end of a roughly \$79k–89k range, and that Fastly was added before a ~14% rally. These notes carry the publisher's own warning, "SUMMARY HAS BEEN ENHANCED BY AI AND MAY CONTAIN ERRORS", so they are reported here as attributed summary and kept outside quotation marks.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
Meta	777.59	+4.50%	\$1.98T	Best of the seven. New 52-week high at 779.82 on volume 134% of average, after Connect (lighter VR glasses, the Muse agent). Closed at 93% of range.
Alphabet	342.36	+1.34%	\$4.17T	Won back 1.3% of Wednesday's 3.8% loss. Still 16.2% below its high; Keith flags a trend break and holds no position.
Amazon	249.38	+0.04%	\$2.69T	Recovered from 245.60. 13.2% below its 52-week high.
Apple	335.92	-0.33%	\$4.90T	Volume only 59% of average. 2.7% below its high.
NVIDIA	224.58	-0.41%	\$5.41T	Largest company, 90% of range at the close. Added to Hedgeye's Signal Strength list Thursday.
Microsoft	497.93	-0.53%	\$3.70T	Back under 500 after reclaiming it Wednesday. A Hedgeye long; 10.1% below its high.
Tesla	377.94	-0.57%	\$1.49T	Closed at 29% of range; the furthest of the seven from its high (-24.2%).

Three up, four down. Combined cap ≈ \$24.3T. Caps are TradingView fields captured 06:09 GMT+8, single-sourced.

6 Positioning & options

- **Vol regime split:** MOVE at 104.6 against VIX at 15.68. Rates volatility is priced at crisis-adjacent levels while equity volatility sits in the lower half of Hedgeye's band. Keith is long bond vol through PFIIX.
- **Hedgeye book:** roughly 44% cash, redeploying into energy and Bitcoin, and short duration (TLT, ZROZ, LQD, JOJO), high yield (HYG), XLU, PSP, IWM, EWA, India, GS, MS and BAC (Macro Show AI summary). The Daily ETF Re-Rank's top movers were **IBIT +10, ETHA +7, MSOS +5** (headline only; the body was not read).
- **Crowding:** Thursday's Signal Strength adds (COIN, HOOD, CRCL, RBLX, NVDA, SNDK) lean heavily into crypto beta. That is consistent with Keith's Bitcoin-for-gold swap.
- **Tape internals:** SPY volume ran 89% of its 10-day average and XLU 115%. The heaviest relative volume was in the losers: materials 124%, RSP 120%.
- **Gap:** no put/call, skew or dealer-gamma data was captured this morning.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR (SPDR)	CLOSE	DAY	RANGE POS.	VS 52W HIGH	HEDGEYE
Communication Services (XLC)	113.99	+1.27%	94%	-5.3%	—
Health Care (XLV)	169.87	+0.63%	40%	-3.8%	Top-3 long
Energy (XLE)	62.60	+0.37%	15%	-5.4%	Top-3 long
Financials (XLF)	54.53	-0.02%	49%	-6.9%	Short GS, MS, BAC
Consumer Discretionary (XLY)	110.32	-0.30%	54%	-11.8%	Top-3 short
Technology (XLK)	194.71	-0.32%	81%	-2.0%	IGV long

SECTOR (SPDR)	CLOSE	DAY	RANGE POS.	VS 52W HIGH	HEDGEYE
Real Estate (XLRE)	41.65	-0.45%	5%	-10.3%	—
Industrials (XLI)	168.83	-0.75%	32%	-10.3%	Top-3 short
Consumer Staples (XLP)	81.70	-0.89%	0%	-9.4%	—
Utilities (XLU)	39.36	-0.98%	0%	52w low	Top-3 short
Materials (XLB)	49.68	-1.19%	16%	-8.3%	—

- **Leaders:** Communication Services on Meta and Alphabet, then Health Care, where Lilly rose 2.68% and UNH 1.00%. Energy was up, but it closed at 15% of its range as crude faded off the high.
- **Laggards:** the bond proxies. Utilities, Staples and Real Estate all closed at 0–5% of their ranges, with utilities on a 52-week low. Materials fell hardest on higher input costs, the same argument Keith used for his BALL short.
- **Rotation:** 3 sectors up and 8 down. All three of Hedgeye's top-three sector shorts fell, and two of its three longs rose. The signal book beat the index on the day.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

Globex had been open 14 minutes at the 06:14 re-pull. ES 7,763 (–4), NQ 30,751.50 (–15.25), YM 51,689 (–28), RTY 2,855.40 (–1.40), on a combined ~**1,900 contracts**. That is too few to count as a direction. Crude opened –0.19% (94.43), nat gas gapped –3.4% on 75 contracts, and gold futures were +0.31% (4,311.20). The first real read comes with Tokyo at 08:00 GMT+8.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Fri 25 Sep	Mainland China shut (Mid-Autumn); Korea shut (Chuseok). German GfK. 20:30 US August durable goods ; consensus was not seen this morning. Fed speakers Williams, Hammack, Schmid ; BoE's Bailey; ECB's Vujcic. Trump–Xi summit continues in Washington. Moody's reviews the EU and Italy late (Newsquawk).
Mon 28 Sep	Korea reopens and prices three sessions of US memory and rates moves in one go.
Tue 29 Sep	RBA decision (per yesterday's edition; unconfirmed this morning).
Week of 28 Sep	US GDP and PCE are due, per a secondary calendar that gave no dates. Unconfirmed.
Fri 2 Oct, 20:30	September payrolls (secondary calendar; unconfirmed).
Thu 29 Oct, 02:00	FOMC decision (27–28 Oct meeting). Odds of a 25bp hike ~70% per TheStreet.

9 Corporate news

- **Costco (after hours):** fiscal Q4 EPS **\$6.75 vs \$6.52** consensus; revenue **\$95.72bn vs \$94.86bn**; net sales +11.2% to \$93.9bn. Shares were +0.22% at \$898.92 in extended trade (Benzinga), a muted reaction to a clean beat.
- **Oracle –3.47%** to 139.54; force majeure notice to the developer of its New Mexico AI campus. Bloomberg and CNBC reported it; the developer was not named in the coverage read. The low was 133.48 (–7.7%), and volume was 145% of average. The stock is 56.7% below its 52-week high.
- **Meta +4.50%:** Connect-week hardware plus adoption of the Muse agent; MarketBeat attributes part of the move to an analyst upgrade.
- **MGM Resorts about –10%** after Barry Diller's People Inc. withdrew its roughly \$18bn buyout proposal. People Inc. keeps about a 27% stake (Stock Titan).
- **TD Synnex –13%** on record results, a sell-the-news move. **Everpure +18.7%** after reaffirming fiscal 2027 guidance; **Charles River +5.4%** after its investor day; **Agilent +3.7%** (TheStreet). **Nebius +7.4%** (Eurasia Business News).
- **AMD +2.38%** to a record close of 629.26, putting its market cap at **\$1.03tn**. **Intel +3.91%** to 127.39. No single catalyst was confirmed for either.
- **Memory split:** Micron +0.81% (1,080.53) against **Western Digital –4.94%** and **Sandisk –3.47%**. No WDC catalyst was confirmed this morning, and older secondary-offering headlines about its Sandisk stake surfaced in search. Hedgeye added SNDK to Signal Strength the same day.
- **Starbucks** is closing about 250 North American stores, roughly 1% of its footprint (TheStreet).

10 Macro data

- **Initial jobless claims: 197K vs 196K** consensus, down 1K on the week (Eurasia Business News, citing the Labor Department). Layoffs remain low. A secondary calendar showed a 196K prior; the discrepancy is noted in §18.
- **New-home sales (Aug): 684K** annualised vs **615K** consensus, +6.4% m/m: a 69K beat despite mortgage rates rising with the 10-year. Hedgeye's housing tickers are all bearish TREND, and ITB/XHB fell about 2.4% on Wednesday.
- **S&P Global flash PMIs (Wed):** composite **58.4**, business activity growing at the fastest pace in more than five years, and job gains accelerating. This is still the dataset behind the hike pricing.
- **5-year auction (Wed):** \$70bn at 5.033%, a tail of more than 3bp. The Thursday 7-year result was **not seen**.

- **Fed:** the funds target is 3.75–4.00% after a unanimous 25bp hike on 16 September. 16 of 19 participants projected at least one more hike this year (Schwab). October hike odds are about 70% (TheStreet).
- **Today:** August durable goods at 20:30 GMT+8. Newsquawk calls it the tier-one US release and says it can move the front end; consensus was not seen.

11 Geopolitics

▼ **Hormuz:** TheStreet reports a commercial vessel was struck in the Strait of Hormuz and one crew member was killed. An adviser to Iran's supreme leader warned of a possible "new front" targeting Red Sea energy supplies. Eurasia Business News attributed part of the oil rally to concern about Houthi attacks. GlobalSecurity counts Thursday as day 209 of the Iran war.

▲ **Talks:** the US and Iran are discussing a **phased deal to reopen Hormuz and end the US blockade**, according to sources cited in wire copy carried by US News and CNBC. Iran is reported to have presented a road map that includes a **60-day nationwide ceasefire** (The National, Gulf News). Neither government has confirmed the terms.

◆ **UN rhetoric:** President Trump threatened to "annihilate" Iran in his UN remarks (TheStreet). Iran's President Pezeshkian vowed never to "bend at the knee" (Gulf News). The rhetoric and the talks are running in parallel.

▲ **US–China:** Xi Jinping is in Washington for a three-day visit. The two sides extended the trade truce, described as two months by Bloomberg and as through January by TheStreet. On AI guardrails, Trump said he expects "no moves", adding "our guardrail is the DOJ" (TheStreet). Taiwan and export controls are on the agenda (NBC); no outcome had been reported at capture.

◆ **Defence and space:** the Pentagon reportedly granted SpaceX exclusive access to classified space-tracking data (TheStreet, single source).

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	STATUS
ES	7,763.00	−0.05%	live 06:14, 14-min session; Thu settle 7,767 on 1.69m contracts
NQ	30,751.50	−0.05%	live 06:14; Thu volume 658,774
YM	51,689	−0.05%	live 06:14; Thu volume 82,620
RTY	2,855.40	−0.05%	live 06:14; Thu volume ~200,100
USD/JPY	158.81	+0.32%	live, ~69-min session; change vs 24h ago
USD/KRW	1,365.85	+0.07%	offshore; onshore shut
USD/TWD	31.850	−0.01%	carries Thu session
USD/CNH	6.7143	+0.05%	live
EUR/USD	1.1378	−0.07%	live
Gold spot	4,272.43	−0.40%	live, ~9-min session
Silver spot	63.754	−1.03%	live
Copper spot	6.6685	−0.10%	live
WTI	94.43	−0.19%	live 06:14; Thu settle 94.61 (+2.66%)
Brent (Nov)	106.49	−0.10%	live 06:14, 5 contracts; Thu settle 106.60
Bitcoin	84,307	−0.11%	live, 24h
Ether	2,684.05	+0.23%	live, 24h

FX, metals and crypto changes are measured against yesterday's 06:01 GMT+8 capture in the archived edition, not against the few minutes of the new session. Asian index levels below are previous closes.

- **Japan reprices higher yields, not a weaker S&P.** The Nikkei reopened Thursday after three days shut and closed at **65,513.77 (+0.76%)** (previous close). Overnight, the US 10-year added another 10bp and USD/JPY rose to 158.8 with the yen on bearish TREND. JGB yields and exporters are the transmission channels.
- **Korea stays shut.** The KOSPI's last close is **7,080.93** (Wed 23 Sep, previous close) and it reopens Monday 28 September. Three sessions of US memory news go unpriced in Seoul: WDC −4.94% and SNDK −3.47% against MU +0.81%.
- **China is shut; Hong Kong trades alone.** Mainland markets are closed for Mid-Autumn. The Hang Seng last closed at **24,761.14 (−0.29%)** and the SSE at **3,888.37 (−1.22%)** (previous closes). Hong Kong is the only China venue open to trade on any Trump–Xi headline today.
- **Taiwan** is also expected to be shut for Mid-Autumn today (**unconfirmed**). That would leave Japan as the only open semiconductor proxy in North Asia.
- **Australia** (ASX 200 **8,702.00, −0.72%**, previous close) opens after its 10-year rose 12bp on Thursday. Hedgeye is short EWA. **India** (Sensex 73,580.54, −1.67%, previous close) is also a Hedgeye short.
- **The single instrument most likely to move: USD/JPY.** It sits at 158.8 with the US 10-year at a 19-year high, the yen newly on bearish TREND at Hedgeye, and the 163.99 52-week high 3.2% away. It is also the only large Asian market with both a full session and a direct rates channel today.

13 AI watch

- **The cost of capital for AI is rising.** Oracle's force majeure notice comes as a 5.2% 10-year reprices every leveraged data-centre plan. The Early Look lists SoftBank's roughly 10%-handle junk deal for OpenAI and CoreWeave's \$1.1bn construction financing.
- **The AI companies with revenue are being rewarded.** Meta's Connect launches (micro-OLED VR glasses, audio eyewear, the Muse personal agent) took the stock to a 52-week high. AMD became a \$1tn company on a record close.
- **Policy:** Trump said he expects no US–China move on AI guardrails ("our guardrail is the DOJ"). Chip export licences remain the live summit variable.
- **Signals:** Hedgeye added NVDA and SNDK to Signal Strength and remains long MSFT, PLTR and software (IGV). Keith has no position in Alphabet.

14 Beyond the markets

- The Treasury's answer to a failing auction was a **\$6bn buyback**, the same size as on 10 September. The Early Look compares it to "trying to put out a wildfire with a bucket of water", and long-end yields rose after the announcement.
- A federal judge temporarily restored White House press credentials for CNN, MS NOW and Politico after blocking the administration's ban (TheStreet).
- Starbucks's 250 closures are about 1% of its North American footprint. In Hedgeye's current map, consumer discretionary is a top-three short.
- More than 70% of S&P 500 stocks are at least 10% below their highs, while the index itself is 1.4% below its high.

15 Appendix — stock cards

AI spenders and earners

META · META PLATFORMS

777.59 ▲ +4.50%

Cap \$1.98T · 52w high 779.82 (today) · vol 134% of avg · next: Q3 results, late Oct (date unconfirmed)

Connect plus Muse gave the market a monetisation story instead of a capex story. It closed at 93% of range with no fade. Hedgeye has no stated position.

ORCL · ORACLE

139.54 ▼ -3.47%

Cap \$422bn · low 133.48 · vol 145% of avg · 56.7% below the 52w high of 322.54

The force majeure notice on the New Mexico campus is the first formal hedge by a hyperscaler against its own build schedule. Buyers halved the intraday loss.

AMD · ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES

629.26 ▲ +2.38%

Cap \$1.03T · 52w high 630.80 (today) · 52w low 157.05 · vol 98% of avg

Record close; a four-fold move off the 52-week low. It rose on a day SOX fell, showing investors choosing between chip names.

INTC · INTEL

127.39 ▲ +3.91%

Cap \$673bn · 52w range 32.89–142.35 · vol 98% of avg · closed at 99% of range

Closed on the high. No catalyst was confirmed this morning; the move tracked AMD's.

WDC · WESTERN DIGITAL

450.31 ▼ -4.94%

Cap \$162bn · closed at 5% of range · 43.7% below the 52w high

Closed near the low while Micron rose. The catalyst is unverified, and Korea cannot price the move until Monday.

MU · MICRON

1,080.53 ▲ +0.81%

Cap \$1.22T · closed at 98% of range · 13.9% below the 52w high

Won back part of Wednesday's -2.2%. Keith's long-MU / short-JPM pair from 23 September is still live.

Consumer, health and credit

COST · COSTCO

\$898.92 AH ▲ +0.22%

Q4 EPS \$6.75 vs \$6.52 · revenue \$95.72bn vs \$94.86bn · not in the price capture (Benzinga)

A clean beat met with a shrug. Consumer discretionary is a Hedgeye short, but staples are not a hiding place either: XLP closed on its low.

LLY · ELI LILLY

1,181.89 ▲ +2.68%

Cap \$1.11T · 8.6% below the 52w high · vol 103% of avg

Led XLV, Hedgeye's top-3 sector long, to 73% of its band.

HYG · HIGH YIELD ETF**77.89 ▼ -0.27%**

Band 77.89–78.76 bearish · 52w low 77.85 · vol 74.9m

Sits exactly on a floor that Hedgeye lowered 41¢ overnight. A close below 77.85 would be a new 52-week low. Hedgeye is short.

XLU · UTILITIES**39.36 ▼ -0.98%**

52w low = close · vol 115% of avg · 17.7% below the 52w high

The cleanest expression of the 5.2% 10-year. A Hedgeye top-3 sector short.

16 About this edition

- **Covers:** the US session of Thursday 24 September (settled 04:00 GMT+8), after-hours earnings (Costco), and the first 14 minutes of Friday's Globex session.
- **Captured:** 06:09:27–06:09:29 GMT+8 (2.2s) via `capture.py`, TradingView primary, 96/96 instruments. Re-pulled at 06:14:03 to establish which rows were live. Yahoo was throttled (0/62), so wire and archive figures served as the second source. Divergences are reconciled in §18.
- **Clock:** the run started at 06:09 GMT+8, 9 minutes after Globex's 06:00 reopen. At 06:09 the futures feed had not rolled and showed Thursday settles. By 06:14 it had rolled onto 14 minutes of new-session trade. FX majors had about 69 minutes of session and spot metals about 9. Crypto is the only full-24h row.
- **Settled vs live:** cash equities, VIX, Treasuries, DXY, ETFs and USD/TWD are Thursday closes. Futures carry Thursday settles plus live 06:14 prints. FX majors, spot metals and crypto are live.
- **Hedgeye edition:** FULL, logged-in feed. The live risk-range set is the Early Look of Thu 24 Sep 19:49 GMT+8, by **Matthew Cooper**. Tonight's Early Look (~19:30 GMT+8) supersedes it. Also read: KM's Top 3, Macro Show Summary Notes, ETF Pro Plus update, Signal Strength Stocks. Bands were diffed against the 23 September Early Look as archived.
- **Quad path:** no explicit path notation seen. The regime is described as Quad 2.
- **Not available:** Chart of the Day, MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant and Capital Allocation Pro did not appear in the feed index since the previous edition. The Macro Week Summary (US Monthly Quad Forecast) was not reached.

17 Sources

Prices. TradingView scanner (96 instruments, 06:09:27 and 06:14:03 GMT+8); Yahoo Finance attempted and throttled. Cross-checked against Yahoo Finance's intraday 24 Sep market piece, TheStreet's 24 Sep close, Eurasia Business News, and this archive's 24 Sep edition (06:01 capture).

Hedgeye. app.hedgeye.com, logged in: Early Look "Nobody Wants the Paper" (24 Sep 07:49 ET); KM's Top 3 Things (07:21 ET); The Macro Show Summary Notes (11:44 ET); ETF Pro Plus update (10:32 ET); Signal Strength Stocks (12:49 ET); feed index. 23 Sep bands from the archived edition.

Macro. Eurasia Business News (claims, new-home sales); Schwab FOMC recap; TheStreet (hike odds); Newsquawk daily economic release for 25 Sep; The Right Trader calendar (secondary, unconfirmed); FedRateCalc (FOMC schedule).

Narrative and single stocks. TheStreet; Yahoo Finance; TradingKey (Meta); MarketBeat; Quartz, CNBC, Bloomberg and Newsquawk headlines (Oracle); Benzinga and GlobeNewswire (Costco); Seeking Alpha, Investing.com and Stock Titan (MGM / People Inc.).

Geopolitics and AI. TheStreet; US News / BOE Report wire copy (Hormuz talks); CNBC; The National; Gulf News; GlobalSecurity; NBC News, Bloomberg, Al Jazeera and The Week (Trump–Xi).

18 Data-confidence**CROSS-CHECKS PASSED**

- **Machine reconciliation:** `capture.py` reported **0 match · 0 minor · 0 DIVERGENT · 57 single-sourced**. Yahoo hit its 5×429 circuit breaker and returned 0/62. There are no divergent rows to resolve because no second machine source ran. That is not a clean reconciliation, so the checks below were done by hand.
- **Cash-index arithmetic against an independent source:** Yahoo Finance's intraday piece printed each index level with its point change, which gives the prior close. Every one ties exactly to TradingView's close minus change. S&P 7,664.35 + 41.68 = **7,706.03** = 7,704.13 + 1.90. Dow 51,139.63 + 371.96 = **51,511.59** = 51,349.98 + 161.61. Nasdaq 26,712.98 + 223.06 = **26,936.04** = 26,939.37 – 3.34. Russell 2,817.80 + 20.86 = **2,838.66** = 2,835.57 + 3.09. VIX 16.11 – 0.93 = 15.18 against 15.68 – 0.51 = 15.17 (1¢ rounding). All five also equal yesterday's archived closes.
- **Futures and rates against yesterday's archived settles:** ES 7,772.50 – 5.50 = 7,767.00; NQ 30,764.75 + 2.00; YM 51,873 – 156; RTY 2,860.20 – 3.40; WTI 92.16 + 2.45 = 94.61; Brent (Nov) 103.08 + 3.52 = 106.60. Yields: 2y 4.897 + 3.4bp, 5y 4.997 + 6.9, 10y 5.110 + 9.8, 30y 5.397 + 9.2, 3m 4.136 + 4.6, DXY 101.114 + 0.135. **All tie exactly.**
- **Brent level:** Eurasia Business News independently prints Brent +3.4% at **\$106.60**, a match. TheStreet's silver of 63.99 (–1.50%) matches SI1! at 64.00 (–1.48%).
- **Basis:** ES–SPX **+62.9pts (+0.82%)**, YM–DJI +367 (+0.71%), RTY–RUT +21.2 (+0.75%). All three are consistent with December contracts roughly 84 days from expiry at a ~4% funding rate, which confirms the 06:09 futures rows were settles. The 06:14 re-pull then showed ES volume reset from 1.69m to 876, which confirms the roll.

- **Hedgeye bands** were measured on the named series: TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER, OANDA:XCUUSD, NYMEX:CL1!, NYMEX:NG1!. The measurements differ materially from futures: gold 46.1% on spot vs 63.9% on COMEX; copper 73.6% vs 100%.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **Closing percentages in press copy:** TheStreet printed S&P -0.07%, Nasdaq -0.06% and Russell -0.17%, against TradingView's -0.02%, +0.01% and -0.11%. The arithmetic above backs TradingView, so the brief uses it. TheStreet's figures look like a 16:00 snapshot taken before the final print.
- **Treasury levels:** TradingView 10-year 5.208% (+9.8bp) vs TheStreet 5.192% (+7.8bp), and 30-year 5.489% vs 5.476%. The 1.3–1.6bp gap reflects TradingView's 18:09 ET mark including post-close trade. The brief uses TradingView. The call that the 10-year closed above Hedgeye's 5.15 ceiling holds on either source; the exact 5.8bp margin is uncertain by about ±1.6bp.
- **Crude:** TheStreet printed WTI 93.12 (+1.04%) and Brent 104.70 (+1.53%), while Yahoo's intraday piece had Nov crude at 95.80 (+3.95%). Neither is a settle. The brief uses TradingView's settle-equivalent last, which ties to yesterday's settle and to Eurasia's Brent. BZ1! is the **expiring November** Brent contract. The December benchmark was not captured, and yesterday's archive showed a ~\$5 backwardation between the two. Treat 106.60 as a front-month print, not the benchmark.
- **Oracle:** TheStreet -6.44% and Quartz -4% against a close of -3.47%. The press figures are intraday snapshots; the low (-7.7%) and close come from the capture. **Meta:** TradingKey +3.75% vs close +4.50%; the brief uses the close.
- **Jobless claims:** Eurasia gives 197K, down 1K (implying a 198K prior). The Right Trader calendar gave a 196K consensus and a 196K prior. The actual and the 1K beat-or-miss are thin marks from a single secondary source. The Labor Department release itself was not read.
- **Nat gas:** the 3.297 "settle" and the 3.209 reopen are 2.7% apart on 75 contracts. The close-above-ceiling finding is robust; the size of any reversal is not.
- **Fed speakers:** Newsquawk's summary styled Williams as "Chair". The Early Look refers to Warsh as the policymaker markets expected to "go easy". The brief names Williams without a title, and the officeholder should be verified before being quoted.
- **FX changes:** FX, metals and crypto changes are computed against yesterday's 06:01 capture, i.e. a ~24h change, not a session change. The in-session changes (e.g. USD/JPY -0.04 over 69 minutes) are noise.

KNOWN GAPS

- **Yahoo Finance:** fully throttled, so there are no multi-day bars and no machine second source for the Mag7, ETFs, FX or crypto. Those rows are single-sourced.
- **Hedgeye:** the feed index since the previous edition showed six items, and five were read (the Daily ETF Re-Rank only by headline). **MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant, Chart of the Day and Capital Allocation Pro did not appear**, and those are the publications that would carry a position change. The absence of a reported change is not evidence there was none. The Quad path lives in the Macro Week Summary Notes, which were not reached. No path notation was seen, and none is asserted.
- **IGV** is not in the capture universe, so its band position is unknown.
- **Macro:** consensus for today's durable goods was not seen. The Thursday 7-year auction result and any housing-starts print were not seen. Next week's GDP/PCE and the 2 October payrolls date come from a secondary calendar and are unconfirmed.
- **Holidays:** mainland China (Mid-Autumn) is confirmed by Newsquawk, and Korea (Chuseok, through Saturday) by yesterday's edition. Taiwan's closure is **unconfirmed**.
- **Catalysts not found:** WDC -4.9%, Intel +3.9%, AMD +2.4%. The Oracle developer's identity and the Costco membership-fee figures were not in the sources read. A rate limit blocked one wire page (BOE Report/Reuters copy on Hormuz); its content is taken from search summaries and other outlets.
- **Options:** no put/call, skew or gamma data.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **Capture window:** 06:09:27–06:09:29 GMT+8, re-pulled 06:14:03. The run started 9 minutes after the nominal 06:00. That was early enough to catch the settles and late enough to see the first 14 minutes of Globex; it did not affect the settle rows.
- **Age of the stalest rows:** US cash equities, VIX, Treasuries and ETFs settled at 04:00 GMT+8, **2.2 hours** before capture. Asian index levels are previous closes: Nikkei, HSI and SSE ~**20 hours** old, and KOSPI ~**44 hours** old (Wednesday 23 Sep).
- **Session length of live rows:** futures 14 minutes (at 06:14), spot metals ~9 minutes, FX majors ~69 minutes, crypto 24h. None of the new-session changes is large enough to count as information.
- **What supersedes this:** tonight's Early Look (~19:30 GMT+8) replaces every risk range above. Durable goods at 20:30 GMT+8 and Friday's Fed speakers can reprise the front end before then.
- **Verify live prices before acting.** This brief is information only, not investment advice.